Teaching Statement

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My teaching experience as an instructor is in undergraduate microeconomic theory, which I taught at Boston College for three semesters with my own sections and materials. Two ideas guide how I teach. Students learn the most when the material challenges them, and they persist when the path through it is clear. Intermediate microeconomics is often the first course in which students have to combine economic reasoning with mathematical modeling, and I try to help them through that step rather than remove it.

How I teach

Clarity comes first. I write my own lecture notes and slides, and I organize each class around a clear sequence from question to model to answer. Organization is the strength students mention most often in my evaluations, and my sections have scored well above the department average on it.

I want students to reason like economists rather than memorize results. In class and on assignments, I ask them to explain why a result holds and what would change if one of its assumptions were dropped, not only to derive it. A student who can explain a result in this way can apply it to problems that differ from the examples in lecture.

I also work hard to make the classroom a comfortable place to be wrong. I learn names in the first weeks, I treat every question as a fair one, and I am generous with office hours and email. One student wrote, "He has high expectations and the material is very challenging, but there are no stupid questions and he is always ready to explain a simple concept."

What I have learned from students

The most common request in my evaluations has been more practice, through weekly low-stakes assignments and worked problems. I added short quizzes in my later sections, and students said they helped. In future courses, I plan to pair each lecture with a short ungraded problem set with worked solutions and to run a review session before each exam. Students also asked for more real-world applications. As a trade economist, I can bring tariffs, trade agreements, and food prices into the classroom.

Experience and evaluations

I taught four sections of Microeconomic Theory at Boston College, each with 22 to 34 students, and my ratings rose each semester. The table reports my most recent section, with 17 of 22 students responding.

	My section	Department
The course was intellectually challenging	4.71	4.38
The course was well organized	4.53	4.24
Assignments were helpful in learning the material	4.53	4.19
The instructor motivated me to do my best work	4.35	4.14
Overall rating of the instructor	4.00	3.86
Overall rating of the course	3.88	3.68

Scores on a five-point scale. Spring 2024, Boston College Economics.

I have also been a teaching assistant for graduate Industrial Organization, Econometric Methods, and Principles of Economics at Boston College, and I ran Stata econometrics labs at the University of Sydney.

What I can teach

I am prepared to teach international trade, international economic policy, intermediate microeconomics, and principles of economics at the undergraduate level, as well as econometrics and statistics with hands-on work in Stata or MATLAB. At the graduate level, I can teach international trade from the foundational theory to current quantitative methods.